

into music players. It is supported by most of the media players owing the Microsoft's push of this format. WMA has substreams which dictate the compression levels and features of the codecs. Lossless audio is possible with some of the substreams.

These are only a few of the various audio formats available. There are devices supporting most of the formats and some are even open source, allowing more freedom in digital audio creation.

Digital Rights Management (DRM)

Within various tech circles, DRM is known as the devil. DRM is used to restrict access to copyrighted work. A library book for instance, has restricted access to only those who are members of the library. DRM does the same thing. It defines protocols and schemes which restrict the free flow of intellectual property. It encourages licensing and prevents copyright infringements. DRM is condemned by many organizations such as the Electronic Frontier Foundation (EFF) and the Free Software Foundation (FSF), both of which criticize the restriction of access to information. In the case of audio, DRM is used to prevent the piracy of music using digital media. DRM adds restrictions on the copying and playback mechanism of devices, based



DRM restricts free music sharing